

FILTER-FEEDING GIANTS

Huge baleen whales use sievelike bristles lining their mouths to strain plankton from the cold water. Humpback whales have a special tactic, surging upward to engulf whole shoals of fish as well as plankton. In the seas around Antarctica, crabeater seals sift the water through their teeth to gather the swarming krill.

▼ AIRBORNE

A humpback whale launches itself out of the water in a spectacular demonstration of its size and power.



STREAMLINED HUNTERS

In the Southern Ocean, penguins, which look so clumsy on land, are transformed into sleek, streamlined hunters as they chase fish underwater. Other fish hunters include the southern elephant seal and the ringed seals of the Arctic. Small toothed whales, such as the narwhal and beluga, also take their share.

TOP PREDATORS

The final links in the food chain are the most powerful polar hunters—killer whales and polar bears. Killer whales roam the world's oceans, but polar bears hunt the Arctic sea ice. Their main prey are the ringed seals that breed on the ice floes. A polar bear can smell a seal from more than 20 miles (32 km) away, and kill it with a single blow of its paw.

